

R **iii** B B O N

R  B B O N

A tapestry of constellations twinkle down at you

The howls of solar wind flavour the surround dunes out of being a complete emptiness,
but you *are* in isolation here, there can be no mistake.

A language coded upon your ribbons is rather hard to make out under raw starlight, but perhaps setting
out toward cardinal directions will reveal the secrets wound upon your arms?

DISTANCE TO
HOMEWORLD:
0.00000000

There is a monument ahead on this hill, our beacon to you.
Only the whispers written down can open the gates ahead.

When it launched, No Man's Sky was a **curveball to expectations.**

Players expected a rich universe of creatures, robots, and billions of combinations of wonder, right out of a comic book. They instead found...



NO MAN'S SKY

Original 2016 version
(i preordered this...)

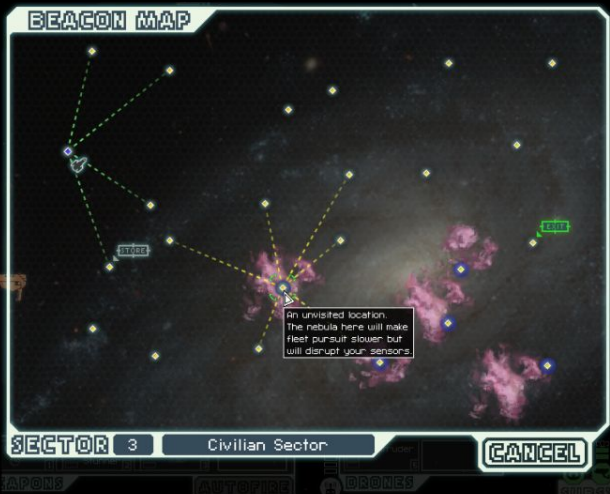
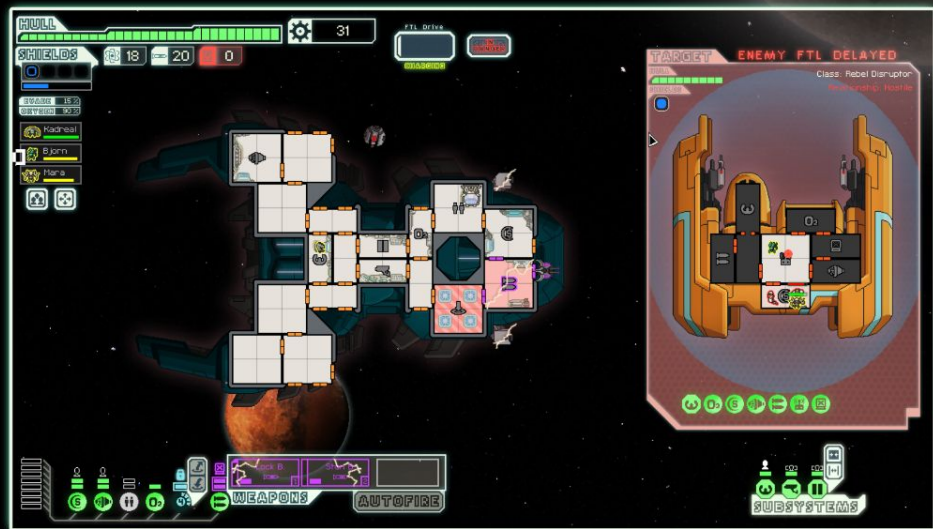
sparser
more
a vast,
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generation
colours
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isolative

2012

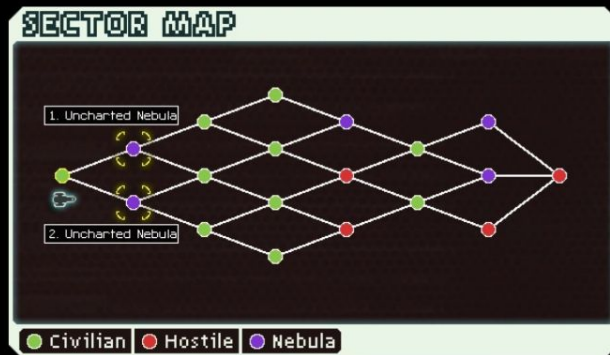
Captain a starship across the galaxy to deliver crucial data to the Federation before the Rebel Fleet catch up to, and destroy you.

FTL introduced the concept of a roguelite in contemporary indie games to many, blending elements of run-based game progression with a procedural story adventure. The exact details and path you can take, differ every single run.

FTL



The player navigates their way back home, picking from randomly generated jump destination for each individual playthrough of the game



R I I B B O N

YOUR WORLD

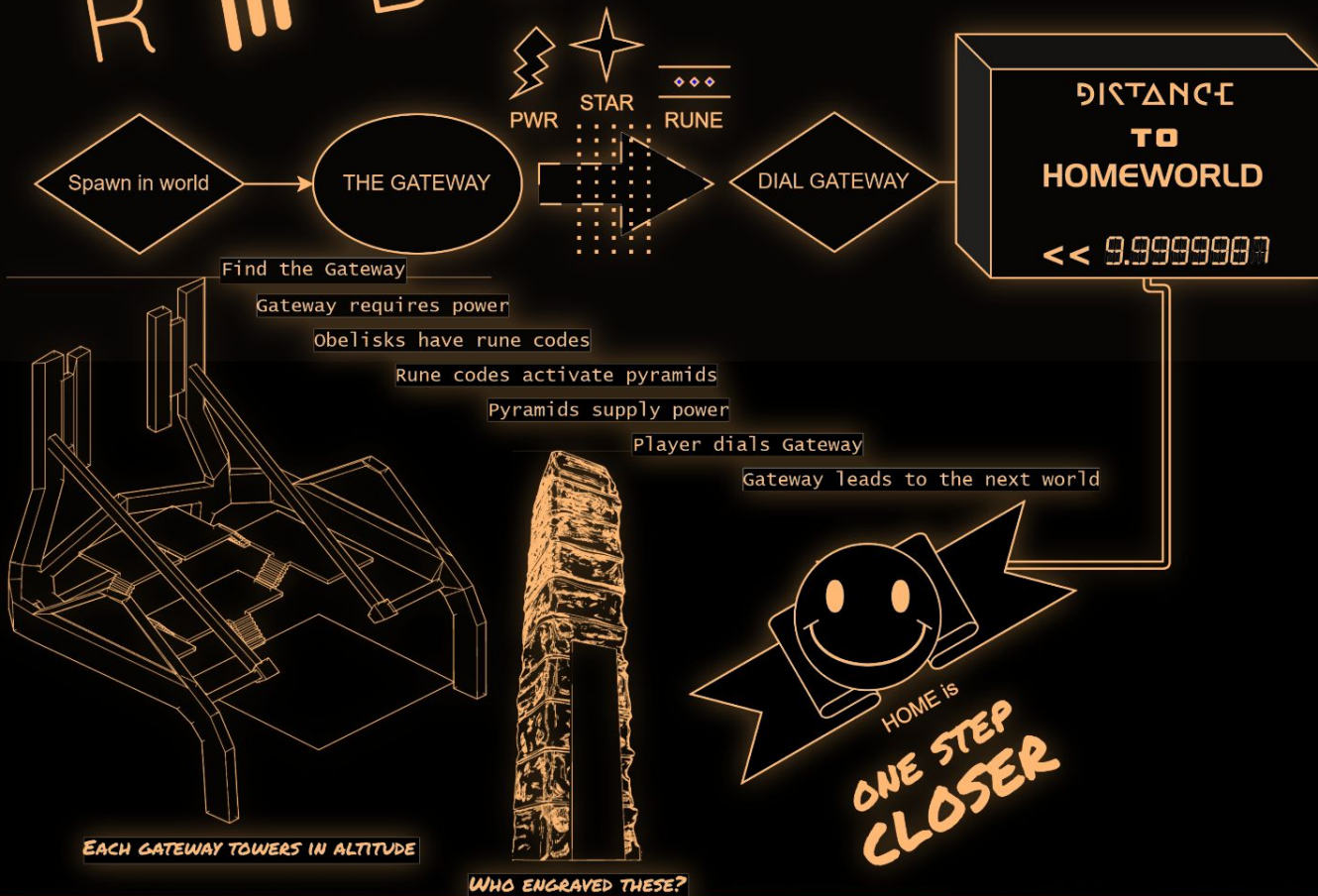
is quite a distance away in the current state of things.

It's up to you to seek out and explore what structures hold the key to make it one step closer on the journey back.

On each world lies a Gateway, a powerful relic built by unfathomable predecessors that devised a network of travel among worlds, capable of delivering you to many constellations you see above.

Ancient stones and ruins among each planet hold rune codes that can engage a Gate with the proper sequences.

You must power the Gateway, and find the correct rune codes that will take you to new coordinates, one step closer to home.



THE NEXT WORLD

My immersive media project from last year tested a presentation flow as a bedrock to continue from:

- Clean art. Vertex shaded. The colour fills the surface.

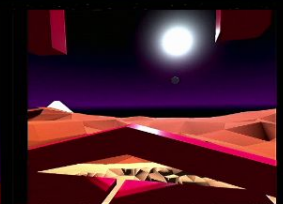
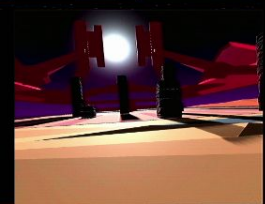
- Less is more. The surface fills the mind.

- Synthesized imposters make wind, waves, a sonic bedrock to complement what we see.

- Scale is everything in VR

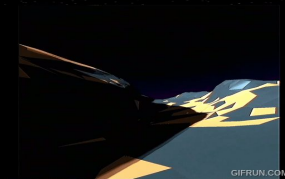
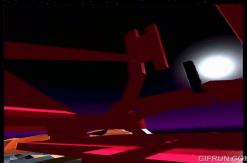
Built during 2024, MONUMENT was an abstract world created with Godot, Blender, Softimage and a Quest 2 to be a surreal "digital" interpretation based on reference photos I took of the Pukeahu war memorial, just north of Block 10.

RIBBON is loosely inspired by the visuals of that project but aims to built upon the presentation with more tangible interactive mechanics & a proper, involved gameplay loop.



PRESENTATION

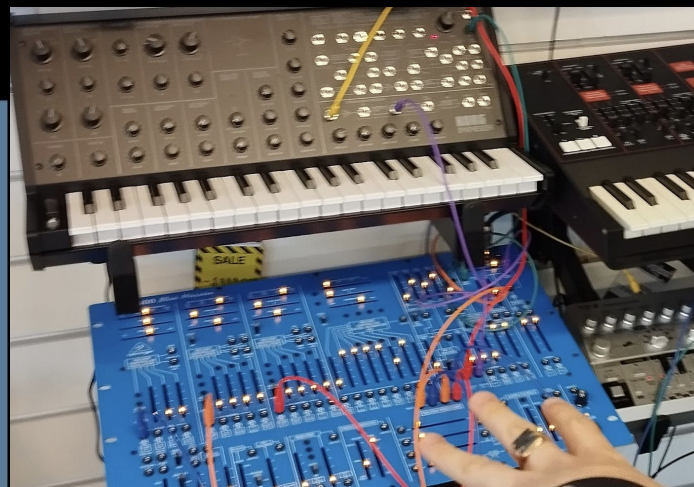
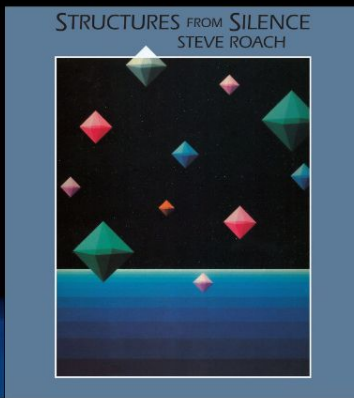
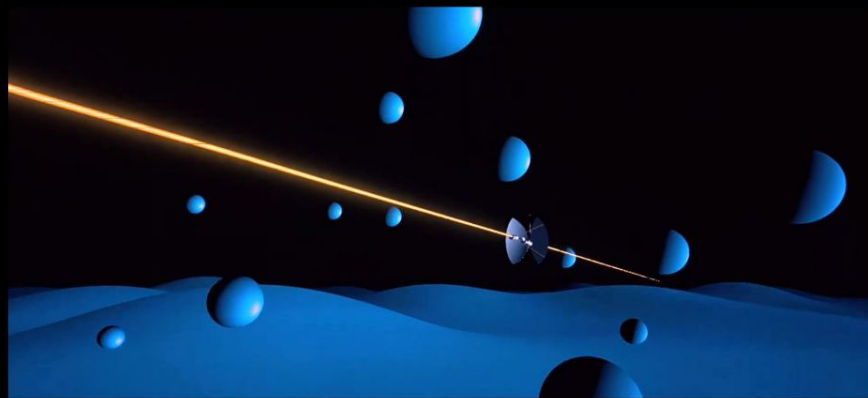
The visual presentation incorporates elements of the early rise of 3D acceleration when IRIX systems with SOFTIMAGE ruled the CGI industry. This approach to visual design is very performance friendly compared to contemporary Unreal Engine titles, and allows for disabling many base rendering features for extra performance with no visible detriment to the art quality.



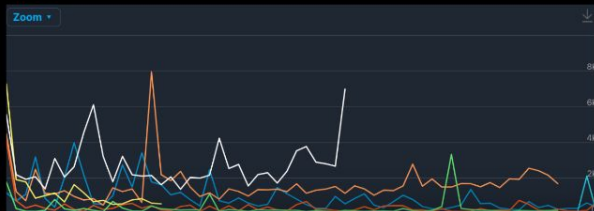
Both *TRON's* score (Wendy Carlos) and Steve Roach's *Structures from Silence* create rich soundscapes through the use of modular synthesizers and electronic instruments. I'd like to explore Unreal's MetaSound platform combined with recordings from modular synthesis to build a "generative" audio bedrock that reacts and envelops the player's senses, contrasting the space from the low-density visuals, and weaving interactive audio into the player's journey and feedback of interactions.

Frame still from:
TRON (1982)

Vinyl cover art of ambient synth album:
Steve Roach - Structures from Silence (1984)



RECEPTION



- “Walking Sim, Relaxing, Exploration” = Small but positive community for shorter titles.
- Often great candidates for sales & bundles as a small price (~\$9.99-\$19.99) with occasional discounts. Frequent on fronts like [Humble Choice](#).
 - Additional monetization via soundtrack, artwork, extending the game identity to keepsakes and products that the community rally behind from the memories they associate.
 - Approx. 40 titles released on Steam with the “WALKING SIM” tag. ~25 in February, but almost all very horror focused. Healthy space for a fresh, unique identity.
 - Deliverable product is a smaller scale goal, targeting ~10-30 minute play time sessions. Ideal target budget, ~\$18,000 over ~10 months of solo dev, as a part-time work endeavour.
 - PC + potential VR support as target platform. This type of game lends very well to XR & direct player interface, especially to capitalize on immersive controls, visuals + audio.
 - Average traffic for many smaller games with a marketing push, between 600-1200 players a week.
 - Project could scale up as additional development is underway - potential to expand scope & gameplay, once the core game loop has been locked down.



Store data

156,850	followers
#449	in top sellers
77,654	positive reviews
3,499	negative reviews
95.69%	positive reviews

Twitch stats

150	viewers right now
548	24-hour peak
78,571	all-time peak 2.2 years ago

Owner estimations

~1.51 M	by SteamSpy
~2.43 M	by VG Insights
~2.62 M	by Gamalytic
~3.33 M	by PlayTracker

Store data

62,315	followers
#1712	in top sellers
70,801	positive reviews
3,388	negative reviews
95.43%	positive reviews

Twitch stats

34	viewers right now
138	24-hour peak
23,257	all-time peak 5.3 years ago

Owner estimations

~3.82 M	by VG Insights
~4.16 M	by Gamalytic
~4.39 M	by SteamSpy
~7.16 M	by PlayTracker

Store data

73,640	followers
#2839	in top sellers
31,957	positive reviews
1,913	negative reviews
94.35%	positive reviews

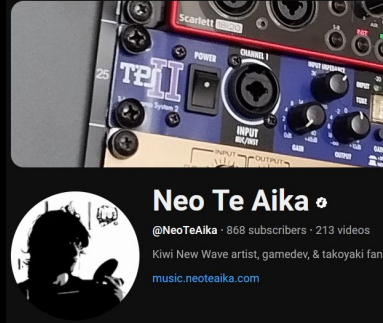
Twitch stats

0	viewers right now
39	24-hour peak
72,437	all-time peak 3.2 years ago

Owner estimations

~873.0 k	by SteamSpy
~1.02 M	by VG Insights
~1.48 M	by Gamalytic
~1.86 M	by PlayTracker

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Neo Te Aika

@NeoTeAika · 868 subscribers · 213 videos
Kiwi New Wave artist, gamedev, & takoyaki fan.
music.neoteaika.com

on most places as..... neo te aika.

https://youtu.be/8_mMn85yEc0
FULL MONUMENT 2024 DEMO

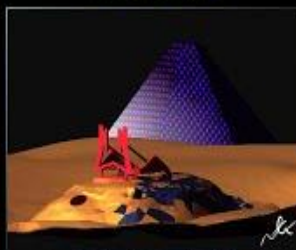


Audio concept music recorded for MONUMENT, also available as a freed download + on my YouTube >>>

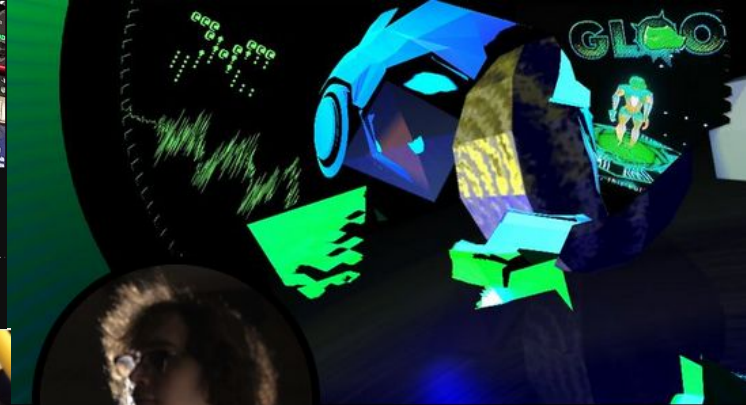


Neo Te Aika (He/Him)

Game & Audio | New Wave Artist | Sound Engineer
Wellington, Wellington, New Zealand · [Contact info](#)



MONUMENT



Neo Te Aika

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@neoteaika

New Wave artist, gamedev, takoyaki fan.

Creating: [@neoteaika_gloo](#), [@Xenotomb](#).

Composer: [@av_hummingbird](#), CLOSURE.

Prev. audio/campaign R&D: [@Halo Digsite](#), VKMT

Musical Artist Pōneke, Aotearoa | Ngāi Tahu

Born July 24, 1999 Joined August 2017

334 Following

1,209 Followers